

Using IDLE

IDLE has two different windows in which you can work. The editor window can be used to write and save programs, while the shell window runs Python instructions immediately.

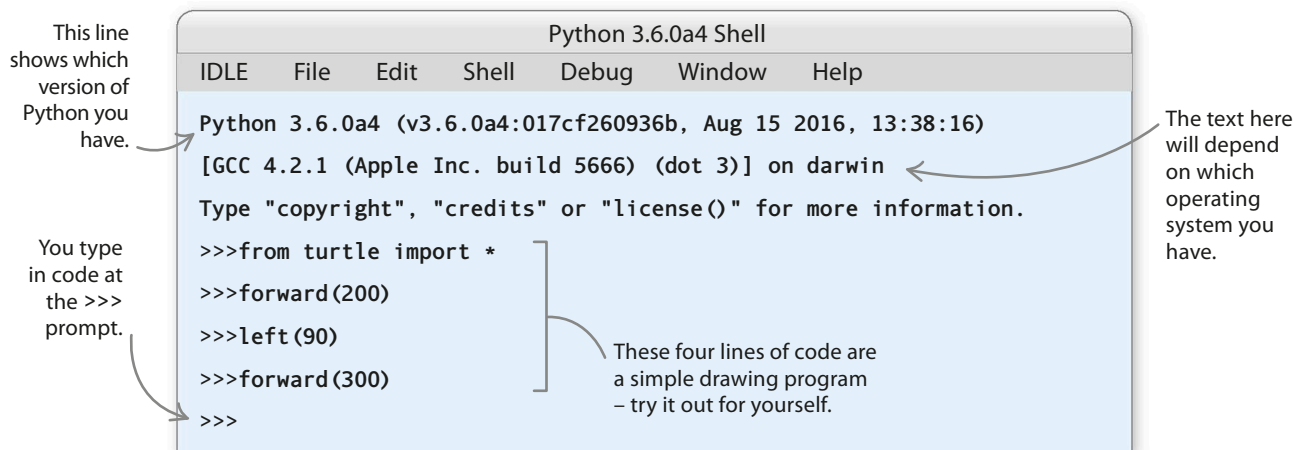


The shell window

When you open IDLE, the shell window pops up. This is the best place to get started in Python, as you don't have to create a new file first. You just type the code directly into the shell window.

▽ Working in the shell

The code you type can be run straight away, and any messages or “bugs” (errors) are displayed. You can use the shell window like a notepad, to test out snippets of code before you add them into a bigger program.



EXPERT TIPS

Different windows

To help you know which window you should type your code in, we've given each window in IDLE a different colour.

Shell window

Editor window

▽ Give the shell a test run

Type each of these code snippets into the shell window and press the enter/return key after each one. The first line displays a message and the second line does a calculation. Can you work out what the third line does?

```
>>> print('I am 10 years old')
```

```
>>> 123 + 456 * 7 / 8
```

```
>>> ''.join(reversed('Time to code'))
```